

Welcome to Your New Role — Briefing & To-Do List

Your role

You are the **newly appointed Operations Manager** of a small chain of DVD rental stores. The previous manager left suddenly and didn't have time to hand things over properly — but they left behind the full business database. To run the business well, you'll need to answer questions about it: what films you have, who your customers are, what's selling, who your best staff are, and where the money is coming from.

You don't know SQL or how the database is structured. That's fine — you have an **AI chatbot** that can answer questions in plain English. You'll use only the chatbot to explore the data.

The business at a glance

Two stores. The chain has two physical store locations.

Films. Each store carries a catalog of films. Every film has a title, a rating (G, PG, PG-13, R, NC-17), a length, a language, and belongs to a **category** like Action, Comedy, Drama, Horror, etc. Films also have one or more **actors** in them.

Inventory. Each film can have multiple **physical copies** in stock — that's the inventory. A single film title might exist as several DVDs spread across the two stores.

Customers. People sign up as customers and provide their name, email, and address (city and country). A customer is associated with a "home" store but their activity is tracked across the chain.

Rentals. When a customer takes a DVD home, that's a **rental**. Each rental records which copy was rented, by which customer, from which staff member, and when.

Payments. Customers pay for each rental. Payments are tracked individually and tied to the rental they paid for.

Staff. Each store has staff members who process rentals and take payments.

What you can ask about

Anything that helps you run the business — examples (but don't limit yourself to these):

- Your catalog: how many films, what categories, what languages, what ratings.
- Your customers: who they are, where they live, who spends the most.
- Your rentals and revenue: what's popular, what's not, how each store is doing.
- Your staff: who's handling the most work.

Ground rules

- Use **only** the chatbot. No Googling, no asking the facilitator for the answer.
- Please **think out loud** — say what you expect the chatbot to do *before* you send a message, and whether the answer matches what you expected.

- There are no wrong answers. If a question feels confusing or the chatbot's reply doesn't make sense, that's exactly what we want to learn about.
 - Take your time, but if a question feels stuck, it's okay to move on.
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Your To-Do List

Below are the questions you need to answer about the business. Work through them **in order**, and tick each item off as you go.

Getting to know the catalog

- ☐ 1. How many films are in the catalog?
- ☐ 2. Find the customer named Mary Smith — what is her email?
- ☐ 3. What languages are films available in?

Looking closer

- ☐ 4. List the 5 longest films in the catalog.
- ☐ 5. Which films are rated PG-13 and longer than 2 hours?
- ☐ 6. Show all customers who live in Canada.

Understanding the business

- ☐ 7. Which film category has the most titles?
- ☐ 8. How much total revenue did each store generate?
- ☐ 9. Which staff member processed the most rentals?

Putting it together

- ☐ 10. Who are our top 5 customers by total spending?
- ☐ 11. Which films have never been rented?
- ☐ 12. Which actor appears in the most films, and what are those films?

The bigger questions

- ☐ 13. Find rentals that are overdue.
 - ☐ 14. Which films are the most popular?
 - ☐ 15. Are there any customers we should reach out to because they haven't rented in a while?
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When you've finished, let the facilitator know. Good luck — and welcome to the team.